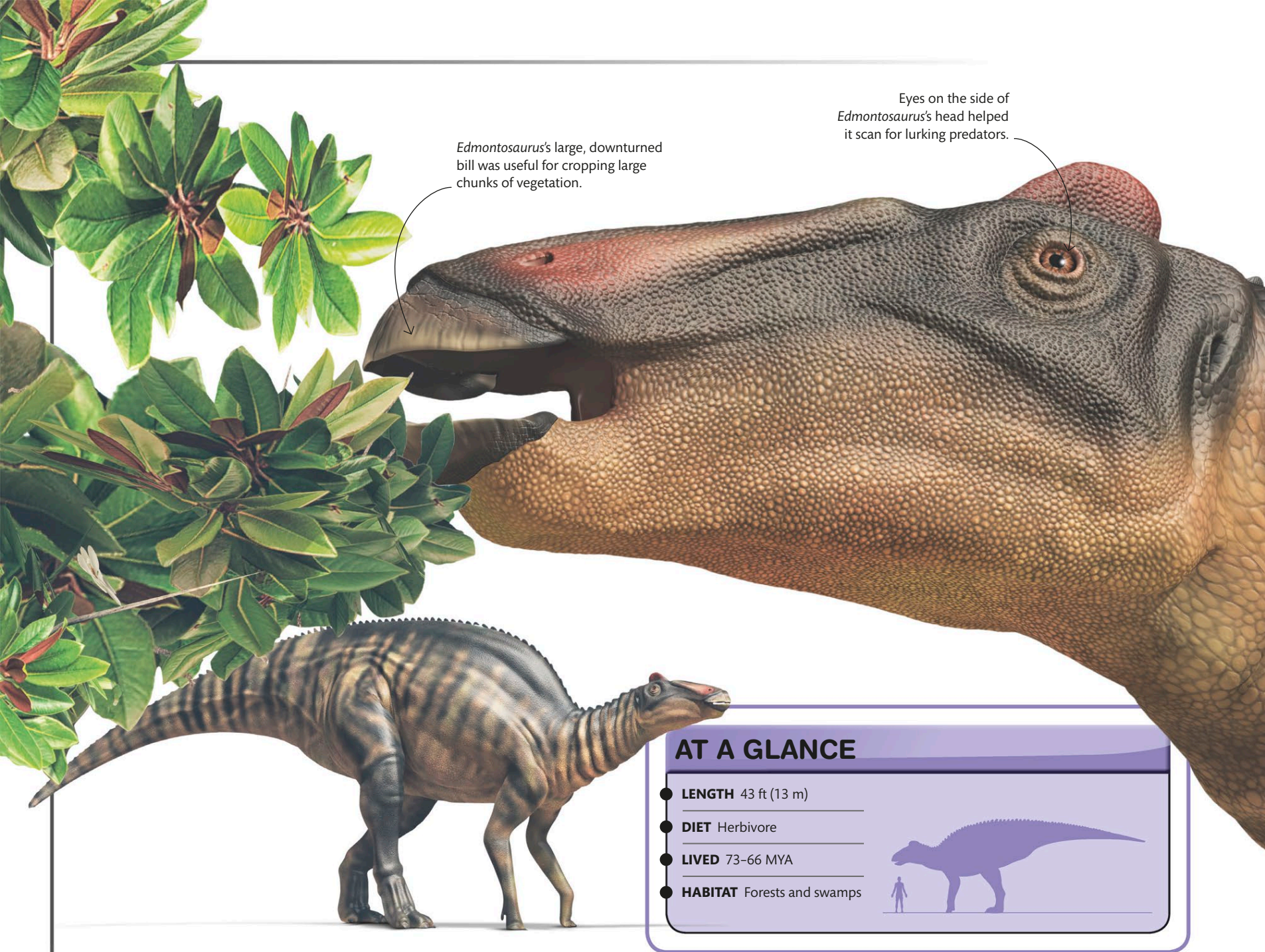




Edmontosaurus's large, downturned bill was useful for cropping large chunks of vegetation.

Eyes on the side of Edmontosaurus's head helped it scan for lurking predators.

AT A GLANCE

- **LENGTH** 43 ft (13 m)
- **DIET** Herbivore
- **LIVED** 73–66 MYA
- **HABITAT** Forests and swamps



PLANT PROCESSOR

EDMONTOSAURUS

One of the last species to evolve from a long line of plant-eating dinosaurs called hadrosaurs, *Edmontosaurus* first appeared in what is now North America in the Late Cretaceous Period, just before the extinction of the dinosaurs. It had almost 1,000 teeth arranged in stacks along its jaws. These stacks—called dental batteries—were the most complex set of teeth ever to have evolved and helped *Edmontosaurus* grind down and swallow even the toughest of foods, including twigs and pine needles. Fossils suggest that unlike most other dinosaurs, *Edmontosaurus* did not shed its teeth and used parts of the roots of older teeth as a grinding surface.